

User Interview Summary

This user interview round collected feedback from multiple anonymous participants. The interviews focused on first impressions of the FROMO prototype, usability, perceived value, missing features, comparison with current event-discovery habits, willingness to continue using the product, and possible pricing models.

Overall, participants understood the core idea of FROMO quickly and responded positively to its map-based, location-aware event discovery concept. Many felt that the prototype could reduce the friction of searching across social media, group chats, search engines, event platforms, university pages, and friends' recommendations. The strongest perceived value was helping users find nearby, last-minute activities when they were bored, had free time, were new to a city, had cancelled plans, or wanted spontaneous plans with friends.

Several features were repeatedly seen as useful. Participants liked the nearby event map, clear distance and time information, event filtering, busyness indicators, route planning, accessibility settings, and the possibility of finding discounts. Some also felt the product could be useful for social plans, casual meetups, or discovering small local activities. The prototype was generally described as clear, friendly, intuitive, and visually appealing, especially on mobile.

However, the interviews also revealed important usability and product gaps. A common issue was uncertainty around booking: participants were not always sure whether selecting or joining an event meant reserving a ticket, showing interest, or moving to another platform. Several participants said the product needs a clearer booking/reservation button, better payment flow, and stronger support for paid events.

Another major theme was trust and reliability. Participants wanted more real events, accurate live updates, clearer information about when an event was last updated, verified organisers, organiser reviews, safety information, privacy settings, and better descriptions. Some said their current methods, especially friend recommendations and group chats, still felt more trustworthy because they already knew the people sharing the event.

The map and location features were attractive but needed improvement. Some participants found the busy-area heatmap interesting, while others were unsure whether it represented real people, estimates, or general activity. A few reported map bugs, slow loading, or location issues on web and mobile. Participants also wanted more control over event type, price range, preferences, and whether they preferred busy social events or calmer small-group activities.

In terms of market fit, participants generally saw FROMO as most useful for spontaneous, low-cost, student-friendly activities rather than major planned events. Discounts were a strong motivator. Several said they would continue using the product if the discounts were meaningful, the event list stayed active, and the information was accurate. For important, expensive, or long-term planned events, they would likely continue using existing tools.

Pricing feedback suggested that most participants preferred a free basic app. They were more open to a small booking fee, organiser fee, or commission on ticket sales than to a monthly subscription. Some suggested optional paid features, such as extra filters, ad-free browsing, or event promotion for organisers.

Prototype ratings mostly ranged from 6 to 8 out of 10. Participants appreciated the concept, visual clarity, and potential usefulness, but lower scores were mainly due to missing live events, limited categories, unclear booking/payment flows, map issues, and the need for stronger trust signals. The interviews suggest that FROMO has a promising core concept, but its success depends on improving event reliability, booking clarity, location accuracy, customisation, trust, and marketing.